

Team Number: _____

Time: _____

Rank: _____



FINANCIAL ANALYST TEAM (150)

STATE – 2020

PRELIMINARY

TOTAL POINTS

_____ (170)

Failure to adhere to any of the following rules will result in disqualification:

- 1. Contestant must hand in this test booklet and all printouts. Failure to do so will result in disqualification.**
- 2. No equipment, supplies, or materials other than those specified for this event are allowed in the testing area. No previous BPA tests and/or sample tests or facsimile (handwritten, photocopied, or keyed) are allowed in the testing area.**
- 3. Electronic devices will be monitored according to ACT standards.**

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Workplace Skills Assessment Program competition.

Description

The team will use strategic planning and problem-solving skills to provide solutions to the business case study provided. At State and National level, teams will be presented with an additional element to the scenario that requires revision of their final presentation.

Modification at State Preliminary Competition

Lynn's insurance costs are increasing for the Boston store next year by 10%.

Initial Case Study Topic

Lynn's Kids first opened in 1998 as a single-store children's clothing boutique in Northampton, Massachusetts. Over the past 22 years, Lynn's Kids has incorporated into a small, private corporation, and expanded to Westborough in 2001 and Boston in 2014.

While sales have remained steady since opening their most recent store, profits have fallen in recent years, and Lynn is concerned that she might have to close her business. Lynn's long-time bookkeeper, Scott, has compiled her financial data for the last five years. Lynn took out a mortgage to buy her first store in 1988, but her other two stores are leased. Lease payments make up 30% of the total operating expenses, with the lease on the Boston location comprising 80% of the total lease payments. Each store has one full-time manager, who makes \$50,000 a year, and the rest of the employees are part-time. The part-time wages constitute a total of 20% of the operating expenses, with the Boston store using 50% of the wages and the other two stores being even. Lynn pays herself a salary of \$100,000 for being the CEO, but she is considering reducing that amount if it means she can save her business. Two years ago Lynn increased her advertising expenses to \$80,000 to try to increase sales, with the 70% of her advertising efforts being focused on the Boston store (20% of advertising is spent on the Westborough store and the remainder on the Northampton store). The remainder of the operating expenses are used to cover insurance, utilities, and other miscellaneous items (these expenses are split in a 30/30/40 split between the 3 stores, with Boston having the highest insurance rate).

Lynn took out a ten-year note to open to Boston store, and she's concerned that sales have not grown enough to cover the loan payments. Lynn has resorted to using the line of credit from her bank to help pay the bills. Between the three stores, the original store in Northampton continues to have the most sales, comprising 42% of the total sales. The Westborough store has the lowest sales, comprising only 28% of the total sales.

Lynn is asking for your advice. She would like to save her business, but isn't sure if maybe she should close all of her stores, close some of her stores, or start selling her clothes online. Please compile Lynn's financial statements for the past five years (assume a 30% corporate tax rate), and prepare your analysis and presentation for the Board of Directors of Lynn's Kids.

A team will be *disqualified* for violations of the [Copyright and Fair Use Guidelines](#).

Teams who do *not* submit an entry that follows this topic will be *disqualified*.